



Play a Face-to-Face Duel

A small tactical card game. This page gets you set up and into your first attack.

WHAT IS THIS?

Build a two-row line of cards. On your turn, send one front-line card into any enemy column. Damage travels **front card** → **back card** → **Life Points**.



YOU NEED

Two people
Two standard 52-card decks - one deck for each player
Two ways to count Life Points - 20 each, using dice, coins, or paper

Why two decks? The software gives each player a full deck. This tabletop version does too.

SET UP THE GAME

1

Choose P1 and P2

P1 gets the first attack. P2 makes the first deployment.

2

Shuffle and draw

Each player shuffles their own deck and draws 12 cards. Put the rest face-down as your draw pile.

3

Make the battlefield

Each player marks four columns with a front slot nearest the opponent and a back slot behind it.

4

Deploy face-up

P2 places one card. Then players alternate, one card at a time, until both fields contain eight cards.

5

Keep four cards

After deploying eight, each player should hold four cards. P1 now begins the first turn.

THE FIRST TURN

P1 attacks. The defender gets the next turn.

You are ready to play. Turn the page only when someone declares their first attack.

1

CHOOSE

Pick one of your front-row cards and any enemy column.

2

RESOLVE

Follow damage through that column. The back page walks you through it.

3

RESPOND

If the attack opened a slot, the defender may reinforce that same column.

4

CONTINUE

The defender becomes the next attacker. Keep going until someone reaches 0 LP.



Take Turns. Resolve Attacks. Win.

Read from top to bottom during play. The rule you need is the one in front of you.

EVERY TURN

1. Attack or pass

Choose a front-row card and any enemy column. That card is the origin attacker; it stays the attacker for the entire combat. If you have no front-row card, you must pass.

A Start with damage

Use the attacker's value. A = 1; 2-10 = their number; J, Q, and K = 11.

B Meet the front card

Subtract damage from it. If it survives, combat ends. If it is destroyed, subtract its value and carry the remainder onward.

C Then the back card

Do the same. If it is destroyed, carry damage toward the player. Empty slots are simply skipped.

D Then Life Points

Subtract the remaining damage from the defender's LP. If it reaches 0, the attacker wins immediately.

2. DEFENDER RESPONDS, THEN TAKES THE NEXT TURN

IF A CARD WAS DESTROYED

The defender may place cards from hand into the attacked column only. Fill the back slot first, then the front. They may keep reinforcing until it is full, their hand is empty, or they pass.

THEN REFILL

The player whose turn is about to begin draws until they have four cards, or their draw pile is empty. No reshuffle. An empty draw pile is not a loss.

SWITCH ROLES

The defender is now the attacker. Repeat this page until the duel ends.

SUITS: USE THESE ONLY WHEN DAMAGE CROSSES THE NAMED BOUNDARY

Apply a shield before a weapon. Do not invent an effect when its boundary is not crossed.



DIAMOND - CARD SHIELD

After a destroyed Diamond, subtract its value from carryover headed to another card.



HEART - LAST DEFENSE

If the final destroyed card before LP is a Heart, subtract its value from player-bound damage.



CLUB - OVERFLOW WEAPON

A Club attacker doubles carryover once after its first destruction, if another card is next.



SPADE - LP WEAPON

A Spade attacker doubles damage that reaches the defending player.

SPECIAL CARDS

Face cards: to destroy a face card, the origin attacker must be a face card of equal or higher rank: J defeats J; Q defeats J/Q; K defeats J/Q/K.
Aces: an Ace is destroyed only by an Ace attacker, and only when that Ace is in the front rank.

Passes: three consecutive passes, or five total passes by one player, ends the game as a forfeit. Passing never depends on whether an attack feels wise.

Win the duel

Reduce the opponent to 0 Life Points. If a combat does that, stop immediately: the attacker wins. Otherwise, defend the column, switch roles, and play the next turn.